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October 6, 2026

60,000 Chickens are Swung and Slaughtered on Public Streets During Ritual Sacrifice

October 10, 2017 by [Donny Moss](#) — [Leave a Comment](#)

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The News

Before Yom Kippur (the Jewish Day of Atonement), a subset of Orthodox Jews in New York City slaughtered an estimated 60,000 baby chickens as part of an annual ritual sacrifice called Kaporos. During the ritual, participants typically pin the chickens' wings behind their backs and swing them around their heads three times while reciting a prayer to transfer their sins to the chickens, who they then deliver to makeshift slaughterhouses where butchers slice their throats.

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In spite of the video footage of showing the Department of Sanitation hauling the dead chickens away after the ritual, ritual participants claim that the animals are donated to the poor. This year, activists for the first time discovered garbage bags filled with hundreds of chickens who weren't used in the ritual sacrifice because they died of heat exhaustion, hunger and thirst in the crates in which they are intensively confined for several days leading up to the ritual.





Thousands of ultra-Orthodox Jewish children pour into the streets to participate in the ritual and challenge the activists who are protesting.

Activists estimate that they saved several hundred chickens from the massacre. The survivors have been sent to sanctuaries around the country where they are receiving specialized care to rehabilitate them after the trauma of having been intensively confined in crates for several days with no food or water.



In Brooklyn, butchers slice the throats of approximately 60,000 chickens and bleed them out in upside down cones on public sidewalks.

In 2015, The Alliance to Ban Chickens as Kaporos sued the NYC Department of Health and NYPD for failing to enforce the 15 public health, sanitation and anti-cruelty laws and regulations that are violated during Kaporos. The case is pending in New York's Court of Appeals, the state's highest court.



Lawsuit aims to stop Jewish ritual that involves tossing, killing chickens on Brooklyn sidewalks



The tradition, called Kaporos, involves throwing chickens and slicing their necks, turning Brooklyn sidewalks into slaughterhouses, according to a lawsuit. (SCHNEIDER, NEIL)

BY BARBARA ROSS  FOLLOW

NEW YORK DAILY NEWS

Monday, July 6, 2015, 8:56 PM

Get the cluck out of here!

A group of Brooklyn residents is suing four rabbis, several Hasidic congregations and the city to stop an annual religious ritual that involves flinging chickens around by their wings and slicing their necks on public sidewalks.

In papers filed in Manhattan Supreme Court, the Alliance to End Chickens as Kaporos, says the "barbaric" tradition, called Kaporos, unnecessarily terrifies the birds and turns public streets into slaughterhouses in the 10 days leading to the Yom Kippur holiday.

The Alliance to End Chickens as Kaporos sued NYC in 2015. The case has made its way to the highest court in NY, The Court of Appeals.

Your Turn

The Alliance to End Chickens as Kaporos is raising money to pay for the long-term care of the rescued chickens and for the groundbreaking lawsuit against NYC for failing to enforce the laws that are broken by Kaporos practitioners. If you have the means, please [contribute](#) to the INDIEGOGO campaign, Justice for the Roses.

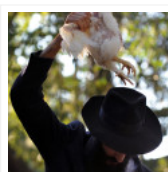
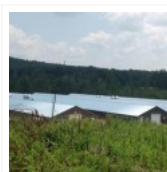




After Kaporos, activists found dozens of discarded chickens in the streets who were still alive. These and the other rescues will live out their lives on sanctuaries.

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Stop this insanity
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THIS BRUTAL AND ARCIAC RITUAL IS BLOODY DISGUSTING, SHAME O. THE JEWIS=H COMMUNITY FOR ALLOWING THIS TO CONTINUE.....
3. *Mike* says:
[October 11, 2017 at 11:30 pm](#)
Stop this now



4. *Alaric Hannibal Barca* says:
[October 11, 2017 at 8:39 pm](#)

If you read your scripture God finds this appalling. Sure he mandated a way to atone. But there are vast numbers of scripture that indicate your goal should be to have mercy on all of animals and God's creation. What you are doing is an abomination to GOD.

5. *Marla* says:
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Disgusting and vile – worthless

6. *Barbara* says:
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Hypocrites as they continue to talk about how they were treated by Nazis. They are no better torturing animals in the name of religion

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